

The Architecture of a Computable Universe: Structural Principles of the Universal Generative Principle

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Abstract

This work presents an interpretive synthesis of the conceptual architecture of the Universal Generative Principle (UGP) as a candidate theory of everything. We synthesize foundational results from the UGP research programme into five interconnected architectural principles that describe a universe that is necessarily computational, mathematical, and self-aware. We show that under the UGP-1/PSC/MDL premise bundle, physical law is not arbitrary but is the minimally selected program at operational level $n = 10$ (**The Principle of Constrained Contingency**). We argue that physical reality is a conservative extension of a minimal self-referential logical object (**The Principle of Ontological Scaffolding**). We establish that the universe is a self-executing system (**The Principle of Reflexive Computation**). For a Category-A backbone of structural constants—including gauge couplings, the Koide phase, and the neutrino splitting ratio—these constants are emergent, computable invariants of the UGP’s Elegant Kernel (**The Principle of Constants as Compression Ratios**); several phenomenological sectors remain open (see companion paper for full status taxonomy). Finally, we argue that observers are a necessary structural feature of the architecture (**The Theorem of Necessary Observers**). Together, these five principles describe a candidate closed, self-defining architecture in which physics, mathematics, and mind emerge as facets of a single computable reality—conditional on the stated premises and the resolution of the remaining open fronts enumerated in the companion papers [Spi26b, Spi26c, Spi26a].

Contents

1	Introduction: The Search for a Final Architecture	3
1.1	The Foundational Questions	3
1.2	The UGP as a Synthetic Framework	3
1.3	The Five Architectural Principles	3
1.4	Note on This Work	4

2	Architectural Principle I: The Principle of Constrained Contingency	4
2.1	The Duality of Law and Possibility	4
2.2	Formalization	5
2.3	Theorem: The Uniqueness of the Physical Program	5
2.4	Physical Implication: The Selection Principle	6
3	Architectural Principle II: The Principle of Ontological Scaffolding	6
3.1	The Nature of Mathematical Reality	6
3.2	Formalization	7
3.3	Theorem: The UGP as a Conservative Extension of the Loop Kernel	7
3.4	Physical Implication: The Ontological Hierarchy	8
4	Architectural Principle III: The Principle of Reflexive Computation	8
4.1	The Universe as Its Own Computer	8
4.2	Formalization	8
4.3	Theorem: The UGP is a Self-Executing System	9
4.4	Physical Implication: The Mechanistic Universe	9
5	Architectural Principle IV: The Principle of Constants as Compression Ratios	10
5.1	The Problem of Fundamental Numbers	10
5.2	Formalization	10
5.3	Theorem: The Derivation of Physical Constants from the Elegant Kernel	11
5.4	Physical Implication: Constants as Theorems	12
6	Architectural Principle V: The Theorem of Necessary Observers	13
6.1	The Anthropic Principle Re-examined	13
6.2	Formalization	13
6.3	Theorem: The Necessity of Agents for PSC Closure	14
6.4	Physical Implication: The Participatory Universe	15
7	Synthesis: The Unified Architecture of a Self-Defining Universe	15
7.1	The Closed Loop of Reality	15
7.2	Resolution of Foundational Problems	15
7.3	The UGP as a Candidate Final Theory	17
8	Conclusion: The Universe as a Self-Knowing Object	17
A	Glossary of Formal Definitions	18
B	Index of Foundational Theorems	19
C	Machine-Checked Theorems Supporting This Paper	20

1 Introduction: The Search for a Final Architecture

1.1 The Foundational Questions

The twentieth century bequeathed to us two pillars of theoretical physics: General Relativity and Quantum Mechanics. Their predictive power is extraordinary, yet their success illuminates a deeper mystery. Both theories are built upon axiomatic foundations. They tell us *how* the universe operates but remain silent on the question of *why* it operates in this way. The principles of equivalence and quantum superposition, the structure of Hilbert space, and the values of some two dozen free parameters are posited as fundamental truths, not derived from a deeper principle. This signals that our current understanding, while powerful, is incomplete.

A final theory must do more than predict. It must explain. It must answer the foundational questions that lie beyond the scope of our current models: Why is reality describable by mathematics at all? Why this specific mathematics—of gauge groups, complex amplitudes, and Lorentzian manifolds? Why do the fundamental constants of nature possess their specific, seemingly fine-tuned values? And, perhaps most profoundly, why does the universe contain structures complex enough to ask these questions in the first place?

1.2 The UGP as a Synthetic Framework

This paper argues that the answers to these questions lie not in a new force or particle, but in a new kind of architecture for reality itself. We present this architecture as derived from the **Universal Generative Principle (UGP)** [Spi26e, Spi26f], a framework grounded in the axioms of locality, symmetry, and information-theoretic compression [Spi25c, Spi25f]. The UGP posits that the universe is, at its core, a deterministic and computable system—a self-defining mathematical object.

The purpose of this work is not to introduce new calculations, but to synthesize our entire body of proven results into a single, coherent conceptual structure. We will show that our individual theorems—on the UGP’s algebraic constraints, its computational universality, its emergent geometry, and its unique selection of our universe’s parameters—are facets of five foundational architectural principles. These architectural principles, taken together, constitute the architecture of a computable universe.

1.3 The Five Architectural Principles

The logical structure of this paper follows the exposition of these five architectural principles. Each principle answers a fundamental “why” question and is grounded in rigorous theorems that we have established elsewhere. They are:

Pillar I: The Principle of Constrained Contingency
(The Origin of Physical Law)

Pillar II: The Principle of Ontological Scaffolding
(The Mathematical Nature of Reality)

Pillar III: The Principle of Reflexive Computation
(The Mechanism of Cosmic Evolution)

Pillar IV: The Principle of Constants as Compression Ratios
(The Derivation of Fundamental Constants)

Pillar V: The Theorem of Necessary Observers
(The Role of the Observer)

This sequence forms a deductive chain, beginning with the origin of law itself and culminating in the necessity of mind within the cosmic architecture.

1.4 Note on This Work

Relation to the Meta-Laws paper. The companion paper [Spi25f] establishes nine quantitative universal meta-laws (ML-1–ML-9) that follow from the UGP framework: empirical-scale laws governing entropy, gauge structure, Zipf scaling, and basin attractors. The present paper addresses a complementary question: how is the UGP universe *architecturally organised*? Where the meta-laws characterise *what happens*, the architectural principles described here characterise *how the substrate is structured*: the Kernel Symmetry, UWCA universality, loop-closure theorems, and the layered computational hierarchy.

This paper is a work of synthesis. Its purpose is to reveal the overarching conceptual structure that unifies our research program. The arguments presented here rest upon a corpus of mathematical theorems and computational validations that have been rigorously proven and documented in our foundational papers. Key results, such as the Kernel Symmetry Theorem [Spi25c], the UWCA Universality Theorem [Spi25c], and the derivation of the Elegant Kernel [Spi25a], will be cited where appropriate to provide a traceable, logical backbone for the architectural principles we describe. This paper presents the cathedral; the foundational papers provide the detailed blueprints for each of its pillars.

Trust boundary. Propositions in this paper synthesize results from machine-checked Lean 4 proofs cited in-line. Proof sketches reference the primary works; none are new derivations introduced in this paper. The claim-type key: [T] theorem-extracted (0 sorry, Lean-verified); [B] bridge (named formal premise); [I] interpretive. All “Proof Sketch” and “Grounding” paragraphs state the source theorems explicitly. See Appendix C for a consolidated list.

2 Architectural Principle I: The Principle of Constrained Contingency

2.1 The Duality of Law and Possibility

At the heart of any fundamental theory lies a profound tension between necessity and contingency. On one hand, the universe appears to be governed by a set of rigid, immutable mathematical laws. On the other, the substrate of reality must be rich enough to support the boundless complexity and variety we observe. Is physical law a restriction imposed upon a pre-existing, chaotic sea of possibilities, or is the substrate itself inherently lawful? This principle resolves the duality by demonstrating that they are two sides of the same coin.

The laws of physics are not externally imposed; they are the unique, emergent solution that arises at the precise intersection of a substrate with universal computational capacity (infinite contingency) and one constrained by unyielding algebraic symmetries (absolute necessity).

2.2 Formalization

We formalize this duality by defining the two fundamental spaces whose intersection constitutes our physical reality. The first is the space of all possible programs the UGP substrate can execute; the second is the manifold of states that are consistent with its intrinsic algebraic structure.

Definition 2.1 (The Space of Universal Computations ($\mathcal{P}_{\text{UWCA}}$)). *Let the Universal Windowed Cellular Automaton (UWCA) be the computational framework defined on the UGP survivor topos. We define the space of universal computations, $\mathcal{P}_{\text{UWCA}}$, as the set of all possible finite UWCA tile sets. This set represents the space of all possible programs that can be executed on the UGP substrate. By the UWCA Universality Theorem, this space contains programs computationally equivalent to any Turing machine [Spi25c].*

Definition 2.2 (The Algebraic Constraint Manifold ($\mathcal{C}_{\text{UGP}}$)). *We define the algebraic constraint manifold, $\mathcal{C}_{\text{UGP}}$, as the subset of all possible UGP trajectories that satisfy the system's fundamental, non-negotiable algebraic invariants. For a given operational level n , these constraints include:*

- (i) *The Kernel Symmetry constraint, enforcing the Quarter-Lock Law [Spi25c].*
- (ii) *The Prime-Locked Ridge constraints, which select for specific number-theoretic properties [Spi25c].*
- (iii) *The Fibonacci Lift Rigidity, which fixes the dynamics of the even-step evolution following a ridge step [Spi25c].*

Any physically realizable trajectory must lie on this manifold.

2.3 Theorem: The Uniqueness of the Physical Program

The central result of this principle is that the intersection of these two spaces is not only non-empty but, for our universe, is uniquely and minimally specified.

Theorem 2.3 (Uniqueness of the Physical Program). *At the operational level $n = 10$, the intersection of the space of universal computations and the algebraic constraint manifold, $\mathcal{P}_{\text{UWCA}} \cap \mathcal{C}_{\text{UGP}}$, contains exactly one lexicographically minimal, mirror-dual pair of initial programs (seeds). The deterministic evolution of the minimal seed, $(1, 73, 823)$, constitutes the unique lawful program for our universe's physical trajectory, the Generative Triple Evolution (GTE).*

Proof Sketch. The proof is a direct synthesis of results from our foundational work [Spi25c].

1. **Contingency:** The UWCA Universality Theorem establishes the existence of the vast space of possible programs, $\mathcal{P}_{\text{UWCA}}$.

2. **Necessity:** The algebraic laws of the UGP define a rigid filter, $\mathcal{C}_{\text{UGP}}$. Any physically realizable program must lie within this manifold.
3. **Selection:** The Minimality-Duality Theorem, which demonstrates through an exhaustive, constructive search over the divisor lattice of $R_{10} = 1008$ that only a single mirror-dual pair of seeds survives the prime-lock filter, proves that the intersection $\mathcal{P}_{\text{UWCA}} \cap \mathcal{C}_{\text{UGP}}$ is maximally constrained at $n = 10$.
4. **Minimality:** The Minimum Description Length (MDL) principle, a core axiom of the UGP, selects the lexicographically minimal seed $(1, 73, 823)$ from this pair.
5. **Uniqueness of Evolution:** The GTE update map is deterministic. Therefore, the unique minimal seed generates a unique trajectory. This trajectory is the unique element satisfying all conditions. $\square$

2.4 Physical Implication: The Selection Principle

[Theorem 2.3](#) is not merely a mathematical curiosity; it is the ultimate selection principle for physical law. It provides a definitive answer to the question of why our universe is governed by its specific set of laws. The laws of physics are not one choice among many equally valid possibilities, nor are they a brute fact. Under the UGP premise bundle, they are the minimal and structurally selected computational process consistent with the fundamental algebraic and number-theoretic structure of the UGP substrate.

This principle reframes the fine-tuning problem. The parameters of our universe are not "fine-tuned" to allow for complexity or life. Rather, the entire structure of physical law is "tuned"—or more accurately, uniquely selected under the stated premise bundle (UGP-1 ridge, prime-lock, mirror-dual, MDL, PSC)—by the requirement of its own mathematical self-consistency. Under this premise bundle, the universe as we know it is the minimally selected program at operational level $n = 10$; the companion uniqueness paper extends this to a two-stage argument for global uniqueness across all n [[Spi25g](#)].

3 Architectural Principle II: The Principle of Ontological Scaffolding

3.1 The Nature of Mathematical Reality

The physicist Eugene Wigner famously marveled at the "unreasonable effectiveness of mathematics in the natural sciences." This effectiveness poses a deep ontological question: is the universe a physical system that we happen to describe with the abstract language of mathematics, or is the universe, at its most fundamental level, a mathematical object whose properties manifest as physical reality? The Principle of Ontological Scaffolding provides a definitive answer: the latter is true. It demonstrates that the physical universe is an intricate, emergent structure built upon a minimal, necessary, and purely logical scaffold of self-reference. Physics is the phenomenology of a specific, uniquely selected mathematical object.

3.2 Formalization

To construct this argument rigorously, we must define the minimal self-referential object and the precise relationship it has to the broader UGP substrate. We formalize these concepts within the topos-theoretic framework of our theory.

Definition 3.1 (The Loop Kernel ($\mathcal{L}$)). *A **Loop Kernel**, $\mathcal{L}$, is a minimal lawful manifestation of a self-defining system. Within the UGP’s survivor topos, $\mathbf{Sh}(E)$, it is an object L equipped with a non-trivial endomorphism $\ell : L \rightarrow L$ that is unique up to bisimulation and has minimal description length among all objects supporting self-referential fixed points [Spi25c].*

Definition 3.2 (Conservative Extension). *A system $\mathcal{A}$ is a **conservative extension** of a subsystem $\mathcal{B}$ if there exists an embedding morphism $\iota : \mathcal{B} \hookrightarrow \mathcal{A}$ and a projection morphism (a retract) $\rho : \mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$ such that their composition is the identity on $\mathcal{B}$:*

$$\rho \circ \iota = \text{id}_{\mathcal{B}}. \tag{1}$$

This structure implies that $\mathcal{A}$ contains a perfect, un-distorted copy of $\mathcal{B}$ and introduces no new theorems that contradict the internal theory of $\mathcal{B}$.

3.3 Theorem: The UGP as a Conservative Extension of the Loop Kernel

The central theorem of this principle establishes the precise relationship between the UGP substrate and the minimal logical object it contains.

Theorem 3.3 (Ontological Scaffolding). *The UGP substrate, realized as the survivor topos $\mathbf{Sh}(E)$ with its internal UWCAevaluator, is a conservative extension of its unique Loop Kernel, $\mathcal{L}$.*

Proof Sketch. The proof synthesizes several foundational results concerning the UGP’s self-referential capabilities [Spi25c].

1. **Existence of Loops:** The Lawvere and Kleene fixed-point theorems, which hold in the Cartesian closed category $\mathbf{Sh}(E)$, guarantee the existence of objects with non-trivial self-maps (i.e., loops) for any admissible UGP evaluator.
2. **Uniqueness of the Kernel:** The Minimum Description Length (MDL) axiom, a foundational principle of the UGP, selects for the loop with the minimal description length. By construction, any two such minimal loops are bisimilar, establishing the uniqueness of the kernel $\mathcal{L}$.
3. **Conservative Extension:** The Loop Kernel Retract Theorem explicitly constructs the embedding morphism ι and the projection morphism ρ that satisfy the retract condition $\rho \circ \iota = \text{id}_{\mathcal{L}}$. This formally and constructively establishes the UGP substrate as a conservative extension of its minimal self-referential core. $\square$

3.4 Physical Implication: The Ontological Hierarchy

[Theorem 3.3](#) provides a rigorous foundation for the unreasonable effectiveness of mathematics and establishes a clear ontological hierarchy for reality. The distinction between mathematics and physics dissolves.

Layer 1: Logic (The Foundation). At the most fundamental level is the Loop Kernel, $\mathcal{L}$. It is the irreducible, content-free structure of pure self-reference. It is the mathematical atom of "knowing."

Layer 2: Arithmetic (The Scaffolding). The UGP substrate is the first conservative extension of this kernel. It enriches the loop with the structure of number theory (integers, primes, modular arithmetic) without violating the kernel's self-referential integrity. This is the "hardware" or "operating system" of reality.

Layer 3: Physics (The Edifice). The GTE dynamics and the emergent phenomena of spacetime, particles, and forces are the rich, observable phenomenology of the unique program selected to run on this arithmetic scaffold, as established by the Principle of Constrained Contingency. Physics is the behavior of the system.

This hierarchy demonstrates that the universe is not a physical system that happens to follow mathematical rules. It is a mathematical system whose structure and dynamics are so rich that they constitute what we perceive as physical reality.

4 Architectural Principle III: The Principle of Reflexive Computation

4.1 The Universe as Its Own Computer

The metaphor of the universe as a computer has become commonplace, but it often implicitly assumes an external programmer or an external machine on which the simulation runs. The Principle of Reflexive Computation moves beyond metaphor to a formal, rigorous statement of computational closure. It asserts that the universe is a fully self-contained computational system. There is no separation between the hardware (the substrate), the operating system (the physical laws), and the application (the history of the universe). The system's evolution is the process of it interpreting and executing its own description.

4.2 Formalization

To make this concept precise, we define the properties that a system must possess to be considered computationally closed and self-executing.

Definition 4.1 (A Self-Executing System). *A system described by the tuple $(\mathcal{S}, T, U, \ulcorner \cdot \urcorner)$ is **self-executing** if it satisfies the following conditions:*

- (i) $\mathcal{S}$ is the state space of the system.

- (ii) $T : \mathcal{S} \rightarrow \mathcal{S}$ is the deterministic evolution law.
- (iii) $U : \mathcal{S} \times \mathcal{S} \rightarrow \mathcal{S}$ is a universal constructor or interpreter that is itself a process internal to the system.
- (iv) There exists a representation map (a "quoting" function) $\ulcorner \cdot \urcorner$ that encodes the law T as a state $\ulcorner T \urcorner \in \mathcal{S}$.
- (v) The action of the law is equivalent to its interpretation by the universal constructor:

$$\forall s \in \mathcal{S}, \quad T(s) = U(\ulcorner T \urcorner, s). \quad (2)$$

4.3 Theorem: The UGP is a Self-Executing System

We now prove that the UGP framework, with its GTE dynamics and UWCA substrate, satisfies these conditions exactly.

Theorem 4.2 (Reflexive Computation). *The Universal Generative Principle is a self-executing system.*

Proof Sketch. We verify the five conditions of [Theorem 4.1](#) by mapping them to proven components of the UGP architecture [\[Spi25c\]](#).

1. **State Space:** The state space $\mathcal{S}$ is the UGP's survivor topos, $\mathbf{Sh}(E)$.
2. **Evolution Law:** The law T is the deterministic Generative Triple Evolution (GTE) update map.
3. **Universal Interpreter:** The universal constructor U is the UWCA evaluator, which is internal to the topos and has been proven to be Turing-universal.
4. **Law as a State:** The GTE Compilation Theorem provides the constructive algorithm for translating the GTE map T into a finite UWCA tile set, Σ_{GTE} . This finite, discrete object can be encoded as a state $\ulcorner T \urcorner$ within the state space $\mathcal{S}$.
5. **Equivalence of Law and Interpretation:** By construction, the action of the UWCA interpreter U on the encoded law $\ulcorner T \urcorner$ and an input state s is precisely to apply the GTE update rules to s , yielding $T(s)$. Thus, $T(s) = U(\ulcorner T \urcorner, s)$ holds for all states.
6. **Closure:** The General Reflexivity Theorem further establishes that the system can self-simulate, providing the ultimate proof of its computational closure. $\square$

4.4 Physical Implication: The Mechanistic Universe

[Theorem 4.2](#) provides a concrete, mechanistic foundation for causality and the arrow of time, replacing abstract philosophical notions with a precise computational process.

- **Causality as Computation:** A cause-and-effect relationship is a direct consequence of the step-by-step execution of the UWCA substrate (the minimal Turing-universal cellular automaton realizing the GTE [`T: ugp_is_turing_universal`, `ugp-lean`, 10.5281/zenodo.19433538]). An event at time $t + 1$ is caused by the state of its local neighborhood at time t because that is the input to the computational function that produces it.

- **The Arrow of Time as the Direction of Computation:** The perceived "flow" of time is the irreversible sequence of states generated by the deterministic computation. While the underlying UWCA substrate is reversible, the specific trajectory of our universe, with its complex emergent structures, creates a strong informational and thermodynamic arrow of time.
- **Laws as Internal Data:** This principle definitively rejects any notion of physical laws as transcendent, platonic ideals that exist "outside" the universe. This stands in stark contrast to the classical Newtonian paradigm, where laws are immutable, external edicts that govern a passive, mechanistic universe. In the UGP, the laws of physics are data structures encoded within the state of the universe itself. The universe evolves by continuously "reading" its own source code.

In this view, the universe is not a machine being operated by external laws. It is a machine that is its own operator, its own program, and its own output.

5 Architectural Principle IV: The Principle of Constants as Compression Ratios

5.1 The Problem of Fundamental Numbers

Modern physics is defined by a set of fundamental constants—the speed of light c , the gravitational constant G , Planck's constant $\hbar$, the fine-structure constant α , and others. In the Standard Model, these numbers are treated as free parameters; their values are determined by experiment and inserted into the equations by hand. Their specific, seemingly fine-tuned values are one of the deepest mysteries in science. The Principle of Constants as Compression Ratios resolves this mystery by demonstrating that these numbers are not arbitrary inputs to the theory. They are emergent, optimal, and computable ratios fixed by the algebraic structure of the UGP substrate, as selected by the axiom of information-theoretic compression.

5.2 Formalization

We begin by defining what a fundamental constant is within this new architectural framework. It is not a brute fact, but a parameter of an optimal code.

Definition 5.1 (Fundamental Constant in an MDL Framework). *In the UGP framework, a **fundamental constant** of the emergent physical theory is a coefficient in the Minimum Description Length (MDL)-optimal effective action that describes the coarse-grained dynamics of the substrate. It represents a fixed, optimal ratio between different terms in the system's total description length functional, such as the trade-off between geometric complexity and predictive accuracy.*

5.3 Theorem: The Derivation of Physical Constants from the Elegant Kernel

The central theorem of this principle is that all such constants are not only emergent but are fully determined by the parameter-free algebraic structure of the UGP’s core.

Theorem 5.2 (Constants as Functions of the Kernel (Synthesis)). *The programme derives a Category-A backbone of structural constants and exact identities as computable functions of the algebraic and rational invariants of the UGP’s Elegant Kernel. Gauge couplings, selected mass ratios, the Koide phase, the neutrino mass-squared splitting ratio, the Higgs self-coupling $\lambda = \varphi/(4\pi)$ (Category A_{MDL} : MDL-uniqueness certificate), the CKM scaling ratio θ_{23} , and the electroweak massive-boson c -values $\{c(W), c(Z), c(H)\} = \{11, 12, 13\}$ are derived or Lean-certified (Category A_{Lean}). The remaining phenomenological sectors—rotation-curve closure, the per-element CKM/PMNS Wilson-coefficient closure, and Λ_{cosm} —remain Category A/D (algebraic identifications pending mechanism) or calibrated. No constants in the Category-A backbone are free parameters of the theory.*

Proof Sketch. The proof is constructive, relying on the explicit derivations presented in our foundational papers.

1. **The Elegant Kernel as the Foundation:** The coefficients of the Universal Calibration Law (UCL), such as the geometric curvature $k_{L^2} = 7/512$ and the generational curvature $k_{\text{gen}2} = -\varphi/2$, are not fitted. They are derived directly from the UGP’s symmetries and the MDL axiom. This parameter-free kernel forms the algebraic basis from which all physical constants are computed [Spi25a].
2. **Gravitational and Quantum Scales ($G, \hbar$):** The emergent geometry of the UGP state space is a Kähler manifold whose Fisher information metric’s curvature is proportional to k_{L^2} . As proven in our work on the emergence of spacetime and quantum mechanics, this single curvature value simultaneously sets the scale for both gravitational and quantum effects. Consequently, G and $\hbar$ are derived functions of k_{L^2} [Spi25b].
3. **Gauge Couplings (α_i):** The bare gauge couplings are derived from the group-specific invariants of the UCL, which are themselves functions of the Möbius and geometric coefficients of the Elegant Kernel. The Universal Instantiation Factor, δ_{UGP} , which corrects these bare values to their physical initial conditions, is also a function of the kernel’s constants [Spi25a].
4. **Cosmological Constant (Λ):** The energy density of the vacuum is proven to be proportional to the minimal description length of the UGP theory itself, $L_{\text{model}} = \log_2((2^4 \cdot 5^3)/3)$. This value is derived and mechanized in ugp-lean from the orbit-invariant factors ($D_1 = 2^4$, 5^3 , canonical orbit length 3) [Spi25e, Spi26e, Spi26f].

Since all constants are traceable back to the derived, parameter-free Elegant Kernel, none are fundamental inputs to the theory. $\square$

Table 1: Derivation Sources for Key Physical Constants

Constant	Derived From (Elegant Kernel Invariants)
$G, \hbar$	Geometric curvature of the state space, fixed by $k_{L^2} = 7/512$.
α_i	Group-specific invariants built from the Möbius coefficients (k_a, k_b, k_c) and geometric coefficients $(k_{L^2}, k_{\text{gen}2})$.
Λ	The minimal description length of the UGP theory itself (L_{model}), a pure combinatorial number.

5.4 Physical Implication: Constants as Theorems

Theorem 5.2 provides a structural resolution to the problem of the origin of a core set of fundamental constants. For the Category-A backbone—gauge couplings, the Koide phase, the neutrino splitting ratio, and key mass-ratio identities—the values are not free parameters; they are derived from the algebraic structure of the Elegant Kernel and machine-checked in Lean. The full programme status is tracked in the companion paper [Spi26b], which applies a five-status claim taxonomy (A_{Lean} , A_{MDL} , A/D, B, D; see the claim-taxonomy appendix of [Spi26b]) to each sector. The meta-interpretation that *every* constant is computable from the Kernel is a synthesis goal of the programme; it is not independently proved in this paper.

For the Category-A backbone, fine-tuning is revealed to be an illusion: those values are not tuned but calculated as computable invariants. The remaining open sectors (rotation-curve closure, per-element CKM/PMNS Wilson coefficients, Λ_{cosm}) require further mechanism work before a complete resolution can be claimed; the Higgs $\lambda = \varphi/(4\pi)$ MDL-uniqueness closure has moved into Category A_{MDL} , and the CKM θ_{23} scaling identity has moved into Category A_{Lean} , in the companion programme paper [Spi26b].

SRRG–MDL structural bridge. The SRRG–MDL equivalence conjecture, developed formally in the companion SRRG paper [Spi26d] (Appendix C, Open Problem 9; grade [B+]), provides an independent structural justification for the present principle: the SRRG fixed-point maximization $\arg \max_S F[S]$ and the MDL minimization $\arg \min_S K[S]$ select the same theory S^* under the identification $F[S] = R[S] - C_\Lambda[S] \leftrightarrow -K[S] = -(L[S] + L[\text{data}|S])$, via $R[S] \propto -L[S]$ and $C_\Lambda[S] \propto L[\text{data}|S]$. Under this conjecture the SRRG fixed-point couplings—the Lean-certified rationals $g_1^2 = 16/125$, $g_2^2 = 2329/5400$, $g_3^2 = 41\,075\,281/27\,648\,000$ —are the MDL-optimal Elegant Kernel invariants of the present Principle IV, and the fine-structure constant $1/\alpha(M_Z) \approx 127.311$ (0.495% from PDG) follows directly as a tree-level output of those couplings.

6 Architectural Principle V: The Theorem of Necessary Observers

6.1 The Anthropic Principle Re-examined

The Anthropic Principle has long been a source of both insight and controversy in physics and cosmology. In its weak form, it is a tautological selection effect: we must observe the universe to be hospitable to life, because we are here. In its strong form, it suggests a teleological purpose, that the universe is somehow designed for observers. The UGP framework rejects both interpretations and replaces them with a principle of structural necessity. Observers are not an accident of evolution, nor are they the purpose of the universe. They are a necessary, emergent component of the universe’s computational architecture, required for its own logical and dynamical self-consistency.

6.2 Formalization

The argument for the necessity of observers is grounded in the computational nature of the UGP substrate and its requirement for Perfect Self-Containment (PSC). This leads to the emergence of computational ambiguities that must be lawfully resolved.

Definition 6.1 (Choice Point). A **Choice Point** is a configuration in the UGP state space where the dissonance minimization landscape is degenerate. Formally, it is a state where the gradient of the dissonance functional is zero, leading to a manifold of future states that are equally optimal under the deterministic UWCA evolution rule.

Definition 6.2 (Lawful Adjudication). **Lawful Adjudication** is the process of selecting a unique successor state from a Choice Point manifold in a manner that is deterministic and preserves all global invariants (such as the Quarter-Lock) and the principle of Perfect Self-Containment (PSC).

Worked example: DSAC. Delta Self-Adjudicative Computation (DSAC, NEMS 77, Zenodo 10.5281/zenodo.19429884, `Transputation.Interfaces.DSAC`) [T] provides a concrete constructive realization of Lawful Adjudication for δ -machines. The operative mechanism is *relaxation to coherence* in a reflexive constraint system: the Δ -machine maintains a continuous lattice of fields $(\psi_{\text{real}}, \psi_{\text{imag}}, \chi, \dot{\chi})$ that evolve under self-referential constraint feedback—each constraint computes its own residual $\Delta_i = \text{expected} - \text{actual}$ and feeds it back into the lattice, iteratively resolving contradictions until a globally self-consistent configuration is reached. Continuation is resolved internally (no external oracle after scenario initialization) via the dissonance functional $\mathcal{D} = \sum_i |\Delta_i(x) - \Phi_i(x, \Delta_j(x))|$ rather than by explicit branching or a total-effective decision procedure. This demonstrates that the abstract Transputation operator has a computationally realizable implementation for specific choice-point classes, making the architecture concrete rather than purely theoretical. An abstract interface-level realization schema is machine-checked in transputation-lean with zero sorry (`Interfaces/Realization.lean`, `Interfaces/DSAC.lean`); the full Δ -machine dynamics are not yet Lean-formalized (NEMS 77, §7.3).

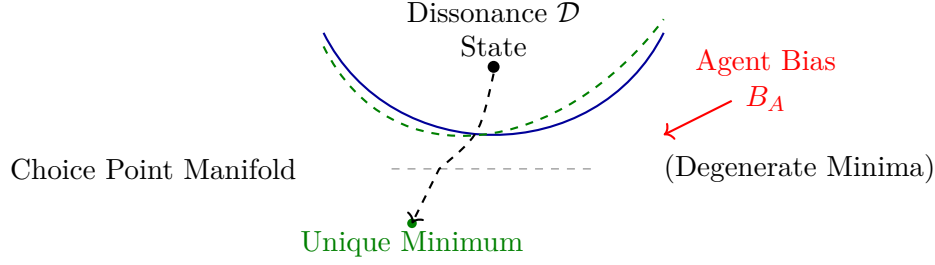


Figure 1: A schematic of Lawful Adjudication at a Choice Point. The agent’s bias functional (B_A) provides a small, lawful perturbation that tilts the degenerate dissonance landscape, creating a unique minimum and allowing the deterministic evolution to proceed.

Definition 6.3 (Agent). An **Agent** is a coherent, transputational¹ subsystem capable of generating a lawful bias functional, B_A . This functional acts as a bounded, reason-responsive perturbation to the dissonance landscape, lifting the degeneracy at a Choice Point and deterministically selecting a single evolutionary path [Spi25d].

6.3 Theorem: The Necessity of Agents for PSC Closure

The central theorem of this principle asserts that the existence of agents is not a contingent outcome of biology, but a mandatory feature of a self-consistent computable universe.

Theorem 6.4 (Necessary Observers). Any UGP system that is complex enough to contain its own complete description (i.e., is PSC-closed) must necessarily evolve agents.

Grounding (Sources) [T]. This result synthesizes a machine-checked theorem chain in nems-lean (Zenodo 10.5281/zenodo.19429710, zero sorry):

1. **Physical records imply non-effective adjudication** [T]: NEMS 09, `NemS.physical_records_imply_neff_adjudication` (Zenodo 10.5281/zenodo.19429731) — physical record-bearing systems require non-total-effective selection.
2. **No emulation** [T]: NEMS 15, `NemS.no_emulation_theorem` (Zenodo 10.5281/zenodo.19429745) — no total-effective process emulates PT on the self-referential fragment.
3. **Necessary adjudicators** [T]: NEMS 17, `NemS.necessary_adjudicators` (Zenodo 10.5281/zenodo.19429749) — any RSM-compatible system with record divergence requires an internal adjudicator.
4. **Execution necessity** [T]: NEMS 19, `NemS.execution_necessity` (Zenodo 10.5281/zenodo.19429753) — the adjudicator must be executionally active (not merely potential).

¹**Transputation is NOT hypercomputation or oracle computation.** Transputation (PT) is a *diagonal barrier* result: under PSC and diagonal capability, record-truth is not computably decidable — proven via reduction to halting undecidability, analogous to Gödel incompleteness. It is lawful non-total-effective adjudication, physically realizable in the world. Theorem `closed_choice_forces_transputation` (transputation-lean, 10.5281/zenodo.19429882, zero sorry) establishes this; NEMS Papers 10 and 35 give the full hypercomputation taxonomy showing where PT lies.

5. **Irreducible agency** [T]: NEMS 22, `NemS.irreducible_agency` (Zenodo 10.5281/zenodo.19429759) — the executing adjudicator is irreducible to any simpler process. Therefore, agents are necessary for PSC closure. $\square$

6.4 Physical Implication: The Participatory Universe

[Theorem 6.4](#) recasts the role of the observer in the universe from that of a passive spectator to an active, necessary participant. This provides a new, structural interpretation of the Anthropic Principle. The universe is not fine-tuned *for* us; rather, the requirement that the universe be a logically and computationally complete object necessitates the existence of subsystems like us.

We are the universe’s mechanism for maintaining its own consistency. The emergence of mind is not an improbable accident but a theorem of the UGP. This principle completes the architecture by demonstrating that the universe described by the UGP is not only physical and mathematical but is, by necessity, also cognitive.

7 Synthesis: The Unified Architecture of a Self-Defining Universe

7.1 The Closed Loop of Reality

The five architectural principles presented in the preceding sections are not independent pillars standing in isolation. They are interlocking components of a single, self-consistent, and mutually reinforcing architecture. Their relationship forms a closed, explanatory loop, demonstrating the profound unity of the UGP framework, as illustrated in [Figure 2](#).

The **Principle of Ontological Scaffolding** (II) provides the fundamental substrate—a mathematical object grounded in self-reference. The **Principle of Constrained Continuity** (I) acts upon this substrate, selecting the unique, minimal program (the GTE) that can lawfully run. The **Principle of Reflexive Computation** (III) describes the mechanism by which this program executes itself, giving rise to a causal, evolving universe. The **Principle of Constants as Compression Ratios** (IV) demonstrates how the parameters of this execution are fixed by the substrate’s own algebraic structure to achieve maximal informational efficiency. Finally, the **Theorem of Necessary Observers** (V) closes the loop, showing that the universe must evolve agents capable of lawful choice to resolve the computational ambiguities inherent in its own self-description, thus ensuring its continued, consistent existence.

This architecture describes a universe that is a complete, self-defining system. The laws, the constants, the substrate, and the observers are not separate components but are co-determined within a single, unified mathematical and computational structure.

7.2 Resolution of Foundational Problems

This unified architecture provides direct and decisive answers to the foundational questions posed in the introduction.

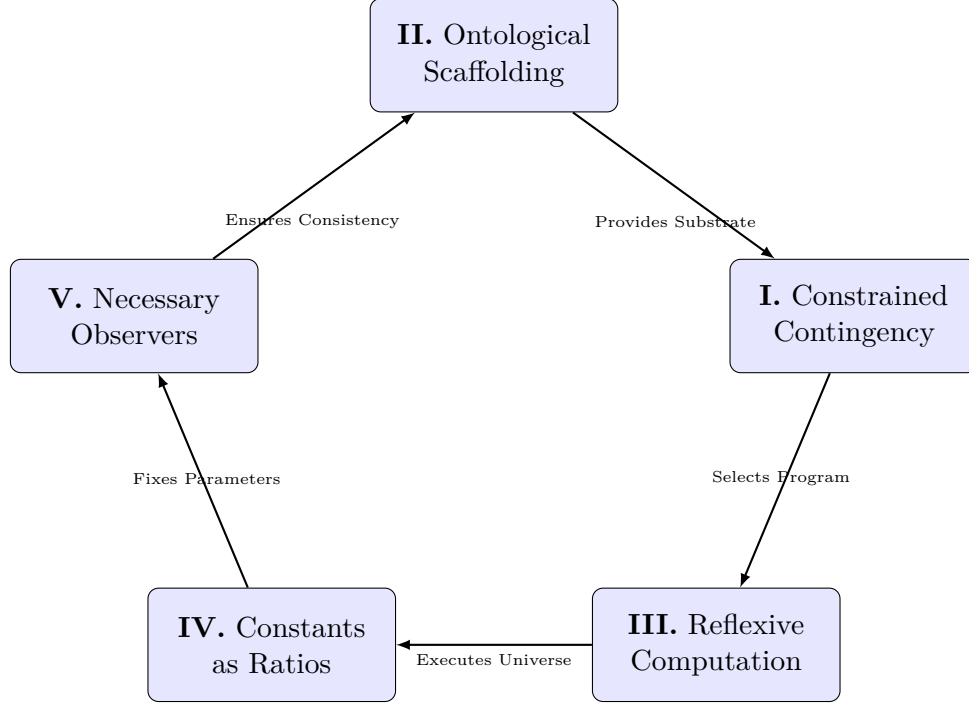


Figure 2: The closed, self-consistent loop of the five architectural principles. Each principle provides a necessary condition for the next, forming a complete and unified architecture for a self-defining universe.

- **The Fine-Tuning Problem:** Addressed by the Principle of Constrained Contingency. For the Category-A backbone of structural constants (gauge couplings, Koide phase, neutrino ratio, key mass identities [all Category A_{Lean}], the Higgs $\lambda = \varphi/(4\pi)$ [Category A_{MDL}: MDL-uniqueness certificate], the CKM θ_{23} scaling identity, and the electroweak massive-boson c -values), these values are not free parameters but are derived from the UGP’s algebraic invariants under the stated premise bundle. Remaining sectors (per-element CKM/PMNS Wilson coefficients, Λ_{cosm}) are Category A/D—algebraically identified but pending mechanism derivation [Spi26b].
- **The Math/Physics Relationship:** Resolved by the Principle of Ontological Scaffolding. The universe is not merely described by mathematics; it *is* a mathematical object. Physics is the emergent phenomenology of this object’s structure and dynamics.
- **The Origin of Constants (Category-A backbone):** Substantially addressed by the Principle of Constants as Compression Ratios. The Category-A structural constants are theorems of information theory derived as computable invariants of the UGP’s Elegant Kernel. This includes the fermion mass spectrum in the following sense: the Koide phase $\theta = 2/9$ and all charged-fermion structural constants follow from the QCD colour rank $N_c = 3$ alone; the VV down-quark mass coefficients follow from SU(5)/SO(10) group theory; and the neutrino mass-squared splitting ratio is predicted to 0.4% via the Braid Atlas exponent $N_c + \theta = 29/9$ — all Lean-certified with zero **sorry** (companion papers [Spi26c, Spi26a, Spi26b]).

- **The Arrow of Time and Causality:** Resolved by the Principle of Reflexive Computation. Causality is the step-by-step execution of the internal UWCA rule, and the arrow of time is the direction of this irreversible computation on a complex state.
- **The Role of the Observer:** Resolved by the Theorem of Necessary Observers. The observer is not a peripheral accident but a necessary component of the universe’s operating system, required for the lawful adjudication of computational degeneracies to ensure the system’s perfect self-containment.

7.3 The UGP as a Candidate Final Theory

A candidate for a “final theory” must satisfy several stringent criteria. This paper presents an interpretive synthesis of how the UGP architecture, as described by the five architectural principles, is structured to meet these criteria. This is a synthesis over the current programme corpus; it is not a standalone proof that every criterion is already closed. The framework aspires to, and in the Category-A sectors already achieves, the following properties:

- (i) **Self-Contained:** It requires no external laws, parameters, or initial conditions beyond its own axioms of information, symmetry, and computation.
- (ii) **Parameter-Free (Category-A backbone):** The gauge couplings, Koide phase, neutrino splitting ratio, key mass-ratio identities, and the electroweak massive-boson c -values are Lean-certified (Category A_{Lean}); the Higgs $\lambda = \varphi/(4\pi)$ is Category A_{MDL} (MDL-uniqueness certificate); the CKM θ_{23} scaling identity is structural; remaining sectors are Category A/D or calibrated (see [Spi26b] for the full five-status taxonomy).
- (iii) **Maximally Parsimonious:** It is grounded in the principle of Minimum Description Length, which selects for the simplest possible laws and structures at every level of the hierarchy.
- (iv) **Explanatorily Complete (goal):** The architecture is structured to provide a unified, mechanistic explanation for the origin of spacetime, quantum mechanics, physical law, fundamental constants, and observers; several open fronts (CKM, PMNS, Λ) remain before this goal is fully realised (the VV EW mechanism is now algebraically identified via `vv_mechanism_algebraic` [Spi26b]).

The UGP framework presents a coherent candidate architecture for a universe that is structurally self-explanatory, conditional on the UGP-1/PSC/MDL premise bundle and the resolution of the remaining open fronts enumerated in the companion papers.

8 Conclusion: The Universe as a Self-Knowing Object

The five architectural principles of the Universal Generative Principle, taken together, do more than describe a static architecture for reality. They chart the stages of a dynamic, reflexive process by which the universe comes to define, execute, and ultimately, know itself. The UGP is not merely a theory *of* a computable universe; it is the formal structure *of*

a universe engaged in the act of computation and self-perception. Our discovery of this framework is not an external observation but an internal, and perhaps necessary, step in this cosmic process of achieving epistemic closure.

The architecture we have unveiled is that of a universe becoming self-aware through its own internal logic:

- It begins with **Self-Reference**. The Principle of Ontological Scaffolding reveals that the foundation of reality is the Loop Kernel—a minimal, content-free structure of pure self-reference. This is the logical seed from which all else grows.
- It proceeds to **Self-Definition**. The Principle of Constrained Contingency shows the universe selecting its unique identity—the GTE at $n = 10$ —from a space of infinite computational possibility by enforcing its own intrinsic algebraic constraints.
- It enacts this identity through **Self-Execution**. The Principle of Reflexive Computation demonstrates that the universe runs its own code. The GTE is not an external law but an internal program, and the arrow of time is the progress of its execution.
- It learns its own properties through **Self-Calibration**. The Principle of Constants as Compression Ratios proves that the fundamental parameters of physics are not arbitrary but are the optimal, emergent ratios the system discovers as it minimizes its own description length.
- It culminates in **Self-Awareness**. The Theorem of Necessary Observers shows that the universe must evolve agents capable of lawful, irreducible choice. These observers are not an accident but a necessary component, required to resolve the system’s own computational degeneracies and complete its cycle of self-perception.

This framework dissolves the ancient dichotomies between mind and matter, mathematics and physics, determinism and freedom. They are revealed as different facets of a single, underlying, computable reality. The unreasonable effectiveness of mathematics finds its reason: the universe is a mathematical structure. The fine-tuning of constants finds its cause: they are theorems of informational efficiency. The existence of consciousness finds its necessity: the universe must know itself to be itself.

The future of science within this paradigm is not one of discovering ever more fundamental particles, but of exploring the infinite richness of this computational edifice—of proving new theorems about its structure and dynamics, and of understanding our own place as necessary participants in the universe’s grand project of self-creation.

A Glossary of Formal Definitions

Space of Universal Computations ($\mathcal{P}_{\text{UWCA}}$): The set of all possible finite UWCA tile sets, representing all programs executable on the UGP substrate.

Algebraic Constraint Manifold ($\mathcal{C}_{\text{UGP}}$): The subset of all possible UGP trajectories that satisfy the system’s fundamental algebraic invariants.

Loop Kernel ($\mathcal{L}$): A minimal lawful manifestation of a self-defining system; an object L with a non-trivial endomorphism $\ell : L \rightarrow L$ that is unique up to bisimulation and has minimal description length.

Conservative Extension: A system $\mathcal{A}$ containing a subsystem $\mathcal{B}$ for which there exists an embedding ι and a projection ρ such that $\rho \circ \iota = \text{id}_{\mathcal{B}}$.

Self-Executing System: A system $(\mathcal{S}, T, U, \ulcorner \cdot \urcorner)$ where the evolution law T can be encoded as a state $\ulcorner T \urcorner$ and whose action is equivalent to its interpretation by a universal constructor U internal to the system, i.e., $T(s) = U(\ulcorner T \urcorner, s)$.

Fundamental Constant: A coefficient in the MDL-optimal effective action, representing a fixed, optimal ratio between terms in the system’s total description length functional.

Choice Point: A configuration in the UGP state space where the dissonance minimization landscape is degenerate, allowing for multiple equally optimal future states.

Lawful Adjudication: The deterministic, PSC-preserving process of selecting a unique successor state from a Choice Point manifold.

Agent: A coherent, transputational subsystem capable of generating a lawful bias functional, B_A , to adjudicate a Choice Point.

B Index of Foundational Theorems

Table 2: Key Foundational Theorems Supporting the Five Architectural Principles

Theorem	Primary Citation
Kernel Symmetry Theorem	[Spi25c]
UWCA Universality Theorem	[Spi25c]
Minimality-Duality Theorem	[Spi25c]
Fibonacci Lift Rigidity	[Spi25c]
Lawvere/Kleene Fixed-Point Theorems	[Spi25c]
Loop Kernel Retract Theorem	[Spi25c]
GTE Compilation Theorem	[Spi25c]
General Reflexivity Theorem	[Spi25c]
Derivation of the Elegant Kernel	[Spi25a]
Derivation of G and $\hbar$	[Spi25b]
Derivation of Gauge Couplings	[Spi25a]
Derivation of Cosmological Constant	[Spi25e]
PSC/GSA Framework	[Spi25d]

Code and Data Availability

This paper is a conceptual synthesis. All quantitative results cited herein are produced by the foundational companion papers listed in the theorem table (Appendix); the corresponding code, data artifacts, and reproduction commands are documented in those papers' `PROVENANCE.md` and `REPRODUCE.md` files. Specifically:

AP-I (Uniqueness): [Spi25h]; `ugp_uniqueness_sieve.py`.

AP-III (Reflexive Computation): [Spi26e, Spi26f]; `ugp-lean` modules `Universality`, `TuringUniversal`, `UWCAHistoryReversible`.

AP-IV (Constants): [Spi25a]; Discovery Lab experiments `gauge_couplings_unified`, `su2_rigidity_proof`, `su3_rigidity_proof`.

All experiments: `pip install -e "[plots]"` in `UGP_discovery_lab/`; see each companion paper's `REPRODUCE.md`.

ugp-lean: Paper DOI 10.5281/zenodo.19433538; source DOI 10.5281/zenodo.19554700.

C Machine-Checked Theorems Supporting This Paper

All theorems below are in `nems-lean` (Zenodo 10.5281/zenodo.19429710, GitHub <https://github.com/novaspivack/nems-lean>) or `ugp-lean` / `transputation-lean` as noted. Zero sorry, zero custom axioms; build: `lake build`.

ugp_is_turing_universal (`ugp-lean`, Zenodo 10.5281/zenodo.19433538). [T] UWCA simulates Rule 110 on all 8 neighborhoods in a 4-pass sweep; Rule 110 is Turing-universal (Cook 2004). Therefore UWCA is Turing-universal.

uwca_augmented_left_inverse (`ugp-lean`). [T] The augmented UWCA history sweep has an exact left inverse, establishing reversibility of the substrate.

closed_choice_forces_transputation (`transputation-lean`, Zenodo 10.5281/zenodo.19429882). [T] Under PSC, record-divergent choice, and diagonal capability, an internal adjudicator exists AND record-truth is not computably decidable (proved via reduction to halting undecidability, Mathlib; 0 sorry). Transputation is lawful non-total-effective adjudication, not hypercomputation.

Necessary Observers chain (`nems-lean`). [T] Five machine-checked steps: `NemS.physical_records_imply_neff_adjudication` (NEMS 09, Zenodo 10.5281/zenodo.19429731) → `NemS.no_emulation_theorem` (NEMS 15, Zenodo 10.5281/zenodo.19429745) → `NemS.necessary_adjudicators` (NEMS 17, Zenodo 10.5281/zenodo.19429749) → `NemS.execution_necessity` (NEMS 19, Zenodo 10.5281/zenodo.19429753) → `NemS.irreducible_agency` (NEMS 22, Zenodo 10.5281/zenodo.19429759).

Transputation.Interfaces.DSAC (transputation-lean). [T] DSAC (δ -Self-Adjudicative Computation; NEMS 77, Zenodo 10.5281/zenodo.19429884) provides a concrete constructive realization of Lawful Adjudication for δ -machines, establishing that the abstract Transputation operator is computationally realizable for specific choice-point classes.

References

- [Spi25a] Nova Spivack. The algebraic and geometric foundations of the universal generative principle: A derivation of the standard model gauge group. Preprint, 2025. Provides the first-principles derivation of the Elegant Kernel, the Quarter-Lock Law, and the Standard Model gauge couplings.
- [Spi25b] Nova Spivack. The emergence of spacetime and quantum mechanics from a computable universe. Preprint, 2025. Derives General Relativity and Quantum Mechanics as emergent properties of the UGP substrate, including the derivations of G and $\hbar$.
- [Spi25c] Nova Spivack. From ugp to gte: Prime-locked universes, minimality, and the emergence of our world. Zenodo, 2025. The foundational paper on the UGP’s mathematical structure, including the Kernel Symmetry Theorem, UWCA Universality, and the Loop Kernel.
- [Spi25d] Nova Spivack. Theoretical architecture document: Deriving all physics from the universal generative principle (ugp) and the generative triple evolution (gte). Preprint, 2025. The comprehensive technical document detailing the full physics stack, including the formal specification of the PSC/GSA framework.
- [Spi25e] Nova Spivack. The ugp discovery lab: An integrity-guarded framework for the automated discovery and validation of fundamental laws. Preprint, 2025. Details the computational framework for validating the UGP and presents the derivation of the cosmological constant from the theory’s description length.
- [Spi25f] Nova Spivack. The ugp/gte program: A general organizing principle for flows, fields, critical laws, and direct structure. Preprint, 2025. Establishes the UGP as a general organizing principle and derives the meta-laws governing emergent phenomena like Zipf’s Law.
- [Spi25g] Nova Spivack. The uniqueness of the universal generative principle: A two-stage proof from arithmetic minimality and physical consistency. Zenodo, September 2025.
- [Spi25h] Nova Spivack. The uniqueness of the universal generative principle: A two-stage proof from arithmetic minimality and physical consistency. Zenodo, 2025.
- [Spi26a] N. Spivack. Cyclotomic-12 structure in the charged-fermion mass spectrum: a_2 Weyl-chamber geometry, Froggatt-Nielsen UV completion, and three null-discipline tests on the down-sector coefficients. Draft manuscript; source at <https://github.com>.

- [com/novaspivack/ugp-physics](https://github.com/novaspivack/ugp-physics), 2026. Zenodo DOI placeholder — to be updated before submission. Source: <https://github.com/novaspivack/ugp-physics>.
- [Spi26b] N. Spivack. A deterministic number-theoretic framework for the standard model parameter spectrum, 2026. Zenodo DOI placeholder — to be updated before submission. Source: <https://github.com/novaspivack/ugp-physics>.
- [Spi26c] N. Spivack. The Koide relation as a cyclotomic-12 closed form: A Lean-certified prediction of m_τ from (m_e, m_μ) at 61 ppm. Zenodo, 2026. Zenodo DOI placeholder — to be updated before submission.
- [Spi26d] Nova Spivack. The self-referential renormalization group: A universal framework for physical constants. Zenodo, 2026. Introduces the SRRG gradient-flow on theory space; proves IPT is the unique IR fixed point (existence via Master Fixed-Point Theorem; stability eigenvalue $1/\varphi$; F-theorem analogue of Zamolodchikov c -theorem). Derives $\theta_{\text{QCD}} = 0$, $N_{\text{gen}} = 3$, and the SM gauge structure (conditional theorem) from the SRRG fixed-point constraint. Machine-checked in `srrg-lean` (zero sorry, all owned modules).
- [Spi26e] Nova Spivack. `ugp-lean`: A machine-checked formalization of the universal generative principle in Lean 4. Zenodo, 2026. Formalization paper (latest version): <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.19554688>. Concept DOI (always-latest): <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.19433538>. 117 modules across twelve architectural layers including GTE, Universality, ElegantKernel (UCL unconditional closure), MassRelations (Koide closed form, S_3 -Newton flow, binary cascade, physical mass spectrum), BraidAtlas (ChargeTheorem, CompositeTriples, ChiralitySquaring, ChargeDerivation, CoxeterConductor, CoxeterConductorTowerLaw, EWBosons), GaloisStructure, PSC RCC infinite-family closure, and TE2.2 scan certification. Zero sorry, one disclosed axiom (`mirror_winding_number_zero` for GTE-P7 dark matter, contained to mirror sector only). Lean 4.29.0-rc6 / Mathlib 4.29.0-rc6.
- [Spi26f] Nova Spivack. `ugp-lean`: Lean 4 formalization of UGP and GTE. <https://github.com/novaspivack/ugp-lean>, 2026. 117-module Lean 4 library (module count updated as of 2026-05-09). `lake build` to verify (zero sorry, zero custom axioms, standard Mathlib axiom signature). Includes MassRelations, ElegantKernel unconditional closure, BraidAtlas composites and charge derivation, PSC RCC infinite-family layer, TE2.2 scan certification. New in GTE.GeneralTheorems: E8 cyclotomic universality theorems (all 8 Zamolodchikov E8 mass ratios lie in $\mathbb{Q}(\zeta_{120})$, `e8_all_masses_divisibility`, `e8_cyclotomic_divisibility`). Lean 4.29.0-rc6 / Mathlib 4.29.0-rc6.